

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) qualified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, integrating, and managing complex security controls across enterprise infrastructure and cloud environments. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel as a Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, combined with deep expertise in incident response, threat monitoring, vulnerability management, and security architecture advisory. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I operate across the full security lifecycle, from engineering threat detections and advising infrastructure teams on security-focused designs to managing third-party security providers and delivering governance activities aligned with ISO 27001 and NIST frameworks. My CISSP certification and breadth of hands-on experience across the Microsoft security stack and broader enterprise tooling make me well positioned to take ownership of cybersecurity controls and strengthen security posture in a complex, professional services environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel - Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection engineering, analytics rules, workbooks, incident automation
- **Microsoft Defender:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, threat hunting, containment, eradication, and post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck - risk-based prioritisation and remediation
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Single Sign-On (SSO), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- **Security Architecture:** Infrastructure and cloud security design, Zero Trust principles, security advisory to technical teams
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Certificate and PKI Management:** Security certificate lifecycle management, Public Key Infrastructure (PKI)
- **Email and Gateway Security:** Mimecast, web security gateway management
- **Firewall and Perimeter:** Check Point Harmony Endpoint, Web Application Firewall (WAF), IDS/IPS, DDoS mitigation
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Third-Party Provider Management:** Security service supplier management, service review, and incident escalation coordination
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design, integrate, and manage Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM, developing custom analytics rules, KQL detection queries, and workbooks to provide comprehensive threat monitoring and visibility across the

UAL environment

- Oversee Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender across an estate of over 8,000 users, ensuring consistent endpoint, identity, and cloud application protection
- Lead incident response activities under NIST 800-61, coordinating with infrastructure teams and third-party security providers to identify, contain, eradicate, and recover from security incidents
- Advise technical infrastructure teams on security-focused designs and operations, providing guidance on cloud and on-premises security architecture aligned with Zero Trust and CIS Controls frameworks
- Drive vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentra BAS, producing risk-based remediation priorities and tracking closure of findings across infrastructure and cloud workloads
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD Conditional Access, SSO, and MFA policies, enforcing least-privilege access and Zero Trust authentication principles for 8,000 user accounts
- Maintain security certificate and PKI lifecycle management, ensuring encryption standards and certificate hygiene across internal systems and external-facing services
- Engage and manage third-party security service providers, evaluating service performance, reviewing security reports, and coordinating escalation of major incidents
- Oversee BeyondTrust PAM platform to control privileged account access, enforce session recording, and reduce attack surface across on-premises and cloud infrastructure
- Conduct threat hunting using Sentinel workbooks and KQL queries, proactively identifying anomalous behaviours indicative of lateral movement, persistence, and data exfiltration
- Deliver security governance activities including risk assessment, control gap analysis, and policy development aligned with ISO 27001 and NIST CSF requirements

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst

- Monitored and triaged security alerts from Microsoft Sentinel, performing KQL-based investigations and escalating incidents with full contextual analysis to senior engineers and management
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across over 8,000 devices, configuring detection policies, alert rules, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified XDR visibility
- Conducted regular vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io, Nessus, and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports for infrastructure and IT operations teams
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID and Azure AD Conditional Access and MFA configurations, enforcing access controls and advising on identity security improvements
- Assisted with PKI and security certificate management, ensuring timely renewal and deployment to prevent service disruption and maintain compliance
- Collaborated with third-party managed security service providers, reviewing service reports, coordinating incident escalation procedures, and tracking agreed remediation actions
- Contributed to ISO 27001 aligned security governance activities, including risk assessments, control evidence collection, and internal audit support

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and maintained security controls across SaaS and on-premises infrastructure, covering endpoint protection, vulnerability management, and identity access management
- Administered Azure AD, deployed MFA, and managed Group Policy across hybrid cloud and on-premises environments to secure user access and enforce device compliance
- Performed security quality assurance and contributed to risk documentation, policy development, and third-party supplier security reviews in a regulated FinTech environment
- Advised on infrastructure security design for cloud migration activities, providing input on access controls, network segmentation, and endpoint hardening

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered custom Microsoft Sentinel KQL analytics rules and detection content that reduced false positive alerts by 40%, significantly improving analyst efficiency and threat monitoring quality

- Led end-to-end Microsoft Defender for Endpoint deployment across 8,000 users, integrating fully with Sentinel to deliver unified XDR capability and consolidated threat visibility
- Established a structured, risk-based vulnerability management process aligned with CIS Controls, reducing critical vulnerability dwell time by over 60% through systematic remediation tracking
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL by identifying and driving remediation of all control gaps across infrastructure, cloud, and endpoint environments
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM controls that eliminated unmanaged privileged access, reducing the privileged account attack surface and supporting audit and compliance requirements

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)